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Kairos in Engineering Building II

When I visited UCF's engineering building II, I found myself in awe of the building's lobby. While the lobby is designed to be a place of collaboration, I found myself feeling excluded and uncomfortable exploring the lobby during my visit in the middle of the day. In the middle of the day, the room is the most crowded, every seat was taken by a focused individual, this made me feel out of place. So despite the room being designed to encourage people to linger, when the context of the room shifts to crowded, people just entering the space may feel out of place. This rhetoric is known as Kairos and can mean that the function of a space behaves differently based on what time and contexts a space is experienced.

My first experience was when I went to take pictures for this assignment when it was crowded, making me feel unwelcome. The space holds around 15 circular tables each with 10 chairs sat around them. A short walk around the space showed every single chair was taken. The only seats available were wedged between 2 actively engaged groups. After realizing I was unlikely to find a seat at one of the circular tables, I decided to look for an open desk at one of the many computers to possibly take a seat, of which every seat was also taken. This is when I left and decided the best place to do my work was in my dorm.

My second experience was when I went for the Knight Hacks club's mentor meeting where the space was used to meet new people, making me feel very welcome, as I am in the club. The event took place at a later hour, meaning the space was less crowded. Despite this, I imagine that while I found comfort in the space during the event, those who were not part of the club did not.

Downs describes Kairos as a word that "translates to something like 'timely good fortune' or simply 'lucky timing' Kairos is the principle that rhetors have far from complete control of their tests and discourses, because circumstances beyond their control can intervene to change the moment and what it makes sense to say in that moment." (page 467) Rhetoric focuses on persuasion and convincing people of certain ideas; however, there will always be things a rhetor cannot control. As seen in the engineering building II's lobby.